

When OpenSolaris boots, enter the username and password and you're ready to go.

5.8.2 Applications

One of the specialities of the new OpenSolaris operating system is the easy deployment of the operating to different computers on a desktop using an application called Crossbow. The file system used by OpenSolaris is called Image Packaging System. The web installation feature makes installation of applications a breeze. A single click on a web page lets you install application without having to download and then compile like other distributions.

Some of the other improvements in the latest build are support for more hardware including the Nehalem based Xeon processors. There is also improved support for virtualization servers.

5.9 Gentoo

Development on Gentoo began close to a decade ago. Gentoo Linux is a distribution which supports some of the widest range of system architectures. Other than x86, there are also builds for PowerPC, IA64, SPARC, PowerPC and even the Sony Playstation 3's Cell processor. Saboyan Linux and SystemRescueCD are two well known distributions that are extracted from Gentoo.

Gentoo Linux is a distribution that many fear and some others love. Many would say it's supposedly meant for the more enthusiastic lot. It is known to be highly customisable and the user gets complete control over the operating system. This would also mean that those installing Gentoo for the first time might find it a difficult to use. For someone who has graduated from Ubuntu to another distribution and then on to Gentoo, it's considered to be at the pinnacle.

5.9.1 Installation

The installer isn't as difficult as is expected. With the CD popped in, you simply press Enter to start the installation. Just before the user interface loads, you'll be asked to enter the keyboard layout. Press Enter to continue at this point. The interface will then load and you'll notice that it looks a lot different than the other KDE and Gnome based environments. There are two ways to install Gentoo – one using the user